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Across Manchester, United extended its winning run under Michael Carrick with a 2-0 home victory over Tottenham Hotspur. Goals from Bryan Mbeumo and Bruno Fernandes sealed a fourth straight win.

Spurs' woes deepened as captain Cristian Romero was shown his second red card of the season, earning a four-match suspension and adding to the pressure on head coach Thomas Frank.

Cole Palmer (**facing page, below**) returned to the spotlight for Chelsea in a 3-1 win, scoring a first-half hat-trick — the third of his career — after an injury-hit campaign.

Arsenal maintained its grip on the title race with a comfortable 3-0 win

Ultimate drama: Deep into stoppage time, Manchester City earned a decisive penalty, which Haaland calmly converted to move to 21 league goals and secure all three points. AP

over Sunderland. Viktor Gyokeres struck twice, while Martin Zubimendi added a long-range effort as Mikel Arteta's side preserved a six-point lead. Aston Villa's impressive run stalled slightly with a 1-1 draw against Bournemouth.

After matchday 25, Arsenal leads with 56 points, followed by Manchester City (50), Aston Villa (47) and Manchester United (44). Chelsea (43) and Liverpool (39) sit fifth and sixth, while Tottenham remains 15th with 29 points.

La Liga

Barcelona enjoyed a routine outing, dispatching Mallorca 3-0. Robert Lewandowski, Lamine Yamal and Marc Bernal were on target for Hansi Flick's side.

Real Madrid secured a 2-0 win over Valencia, with Álvaro Carreras and Kylian Mbappe among the goals. Atletico Madrid endured a disappointing week, slipping to a 1-0 defeat against Real Betis.

Antony's 28th-minute strike proved decisive, handing Diego Simeone's men their fourth league loss of the season.

The Basque clubs impressed, with Athletic Bilbao defeating 10-man Levante 4-2 — Gorka Guruzeta scoring twice — while Real Sociedad beat Elche 3-1.

After matchday 23, Barcelona tops the table with 58 points, just ahead of Real Madrid (57). Atletico (45) and Villarreal (42) complete the top four.

Ligue 1

Reigning champion Paris Saint-Germain sent a strong message in the title race as it thumped fourth-placed Olympique de Marseille 5-0.

Ballon d'Or winner Ousmane Dembele (**below, left**) led from the front with a brace, while Facundo Medina, Khvicha Kvaratskhelia and Lee Kang-in also got on the scoresheet.

Surprise challenger RC Lens, meanwhile, managed to secure a 3-1 win against Stade Rennais despite playing the last half hour with just ten men. Only two points separate second-placed Lens and PSG with 13 games left to be played this season.

Bundesliga

Bayern Munich stayed firmly on course for another title with a dominant 5-1 win over Hoffenheim. Harry Kane scored twice, while Luis Diaz netted a hat-trick.

Kane now leads the Bundesliga Golden Boot race with 24 goals and



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